Subject: **DSPS Testing Space: Process, Participation, and Request for Input**

Colleagues,

As many of you know, the college needs to identify an appropriate location for a dedicated DSPS proctored testing space. This is both a student access issue and a compliance issue, making it an important institutional priority.

No potential location has been selected for recommendation, and all suggested locations will be evaluated through the established space repurposing process. President Art Pimentel has reaffirmed the college's commitment to following that process before any recommendation is made.

As faculty co-chair of the Budget and Facilities Planning Committee (BFPC), I want to raise faculty awareness of this issue before the fall semester. Because faculty are currently off contract, I do not want to begin the broader space allocation discussion by email. Instead, I hope to encourage faculty to begin thinking about potential locations so that we can begin the fall discussion with a broad range of possibilities already identified. BFPC will oversee and review the process, gather input from the campus community, facilitate the campus discussion, and ultimately forward its recommendations to the President.

To support that process, BFPC will host a town hall during the second week of the fall semester with the objective of initiating a broader campus discussion about DSPS space allocation. Faculty and other stakeholders will have an opportunity to ask questions, suggest potential locations for consideration, and provide feedback as the process moves forward. By raising faculty awareness of this issue now, I hope to provide everyone with additional time to reflect on the issue, identify potential locations, and submit thoughtful suggestions before recommendations are developed.

To help make the process as transparent as possible, I also want to share the primary considerations that will help inform the evaluation of potential locations.

1. Space Utilization

The college seeks to minimize disruption to existing instructional and operational activities. In general, spaces with lower overall utilization are easier to repurpose while reducing impacts on students, faculty, and programs.

2. DSPS Staff Adjacency

DSPS staff will need to access the testing center frequently throughout the day. Locating the space near existing DSPS operations improves efficiency and better supports students during testing.

3. Existing Infrastructure

A dedicated testing center requires significant network, technology, and security infrastructure. Spaces that already have much of this infrastructure in place are generally less expensive to renovate and can be brought online more quickly.

If you are aware of a location that you believe should be considered, I invite you to submit it using the Google Form below.

Google Form: https://forms.gle/M7SN8WJeh3QqhApo9

Please include the room number or location and a brief explanation of why you believe the space merits consideration. All submitted locations will become part of the broader space allocation discussion as the facilities planning process moves forward.

My objective is to ensure that the process is as transparent and inclusive as possible, that faculty voices are heard early, and that the college's eventual decision reflects a thoughtful evaluation of the available options while meeting our responsibility to provide an appropriate DSPS testing environment for students.

If you have questions about the process, the evaluation criteria, or would simply like to discuss the issue, please feel free to reach out to me directly. I am happy to answer questions or hear your thoughts. Thank you in advance for your thoughtful input. I look forward to working with all of you on this important issue.

Best,

Caleb Fowler

Faculty Co-Chair

Budget and Facilities Planning Committee